INTRODUCTION

The September 11, 2001 attacks on the twin towers of the World Trade Center, New York, the symbol of prowess and of prestige of the most powerful state in the world, came as a rude shock not only to the Americans but also to the people in other parts of the world. The attacks signalled to the fact that states are no longer impermeable and even a superpower like the United States of America can easily become a victim of attacks launched, not by states but by invisible actors, the most dangerous being the forces of terrorism, which are at work globally.